

Card 5: Hackles or Not?

The Hackles Kit

Hackles · a free kit · quillsup.org · October 2026

Hackles Lab · Teacher card · Grades 2-8 · [hackles-or-not/index.html](#)

Learning goal. Practice the whole routine: notice (hackles up?), choose moves (Pause, Check, Tell), and use the Next-Rung Rule when the first adult does not help.

SPECIMEN LABEL	
10 MIN	Gut check tab: 8 situations. Pick Hackles up, down or Not sure, choose moves, read what the kit recommends.
20 MIN	Add Help Ladder practice: 5 scenes where the first person did not help. Choose the next step, then say the three sentence starters aloud in pairs.

Screens. Situation card, hackles answer with the kit's view and why, moves and comparison, then the Help Ladder (you, a friend, a trusted adult, a report) with the Good Grown-up Reply.

Tone. Nothing is "wrong". A false alarm is welcome, "Not sure" is a smart answer, extra moves are never marked down. Do not score it.

Content. 20 invented situations. Sensitive topics (secret chats with strangers, picture requests, threats) are left out on purpose, so no counselor heads-up is needed. Say rungs by name, because guides number them differently.

If a student discloses. Thank them, say "It is not your fault and you are not in trouble", promise no secrecy, and follow your school process that day.

Standards (approximate; verify). CSTA 1B-NI-05; ISTE 2b; CASEL Relationship Skills.

Accessibility. Answers differ by shape, word and border. Feedback announced; focus moves to the new message. Arrow-key tabs. Spanish draft.

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